

Zero Hormuz Monitor — UAE port activity during the Hormuz closure

UAE Gulf coast (13 ports) + east coast (Fujairah, Khor Fakkan) · 1 Mar to 25 Sep 2026 · M3 reference · million estimated tonnes

Containers	General cargo + RoRo	Dry bulk	Tankers	Non-tankers	Total
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Activity preserved (M3)
M3 · 1 Mar–25 Sep 2026 · Gulf + east coast

27.7%

Sensitivity range M1–M5
Minimum and maximum across the 5 references

26.2% to 28.2%

Residual gap (Mt)
Difference from the historical reference

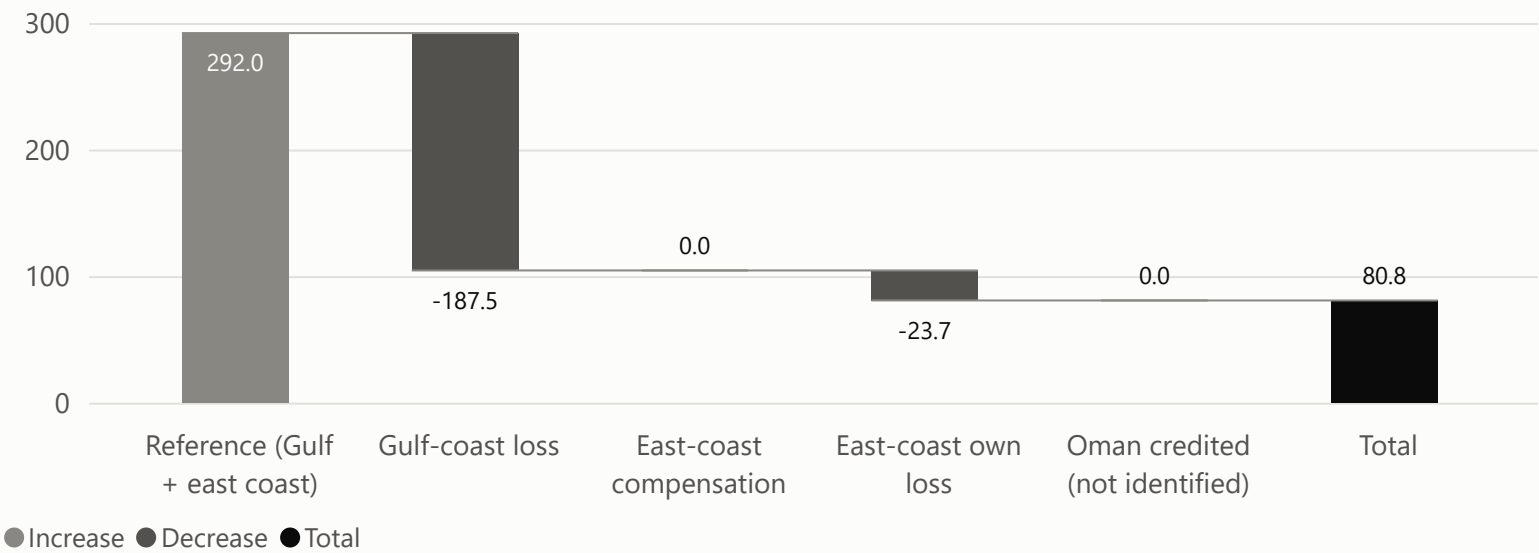
211.3

East-coast change (Mt)
+ compensation / – own loss

-23.7

Activity preserved, Total: 27.7% of the M3 reference (1 Mar to 25 Sep 2026)

From the M3 reference to observed activity (Mt). The final "Total" bar is observed activity.



How to read this page

- **Activity preserved:** observed tonnes at UAE Gulf-coast and east-coast ports as a percentage of the M3 reference (same weekday, 52 and 104 weeks earlier).
- **Residual gap:** "Difference in activity relative to the historical reference; its recovery and possible redistribution are assessed through separate scenarios."
- **Oman:** "Attributable volume not identified; no compensation credited."
- **Sensitivity range M1–M5:** how much the result changes with the chosen reference; it is not a confidence interval.
- Tankers are read separately. No figure on this page is port capacity.
- Validation: PortWatch matches DP World on the Jebel Ali change (Q2: –90.9% vs –90.1%). See the Method page.

Weekly evolution vs the reference

Weeks ending Sunday · M3 reference · the last week of port data (21–25 Sep) is partial: read it as a percentage

Containers

General cargo + RoRo

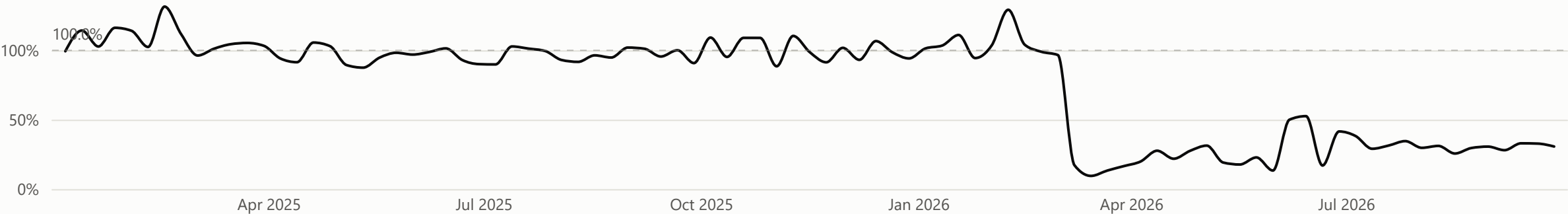
Dry bulk

Tankers

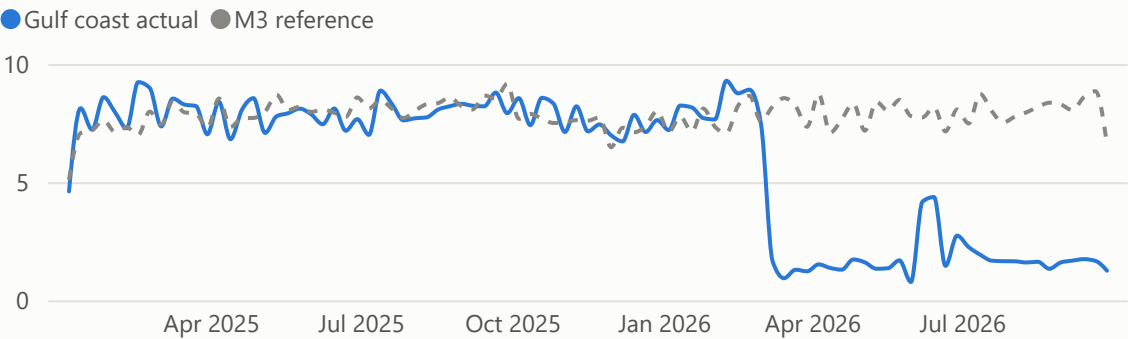
1/1/2025

9/27/2026

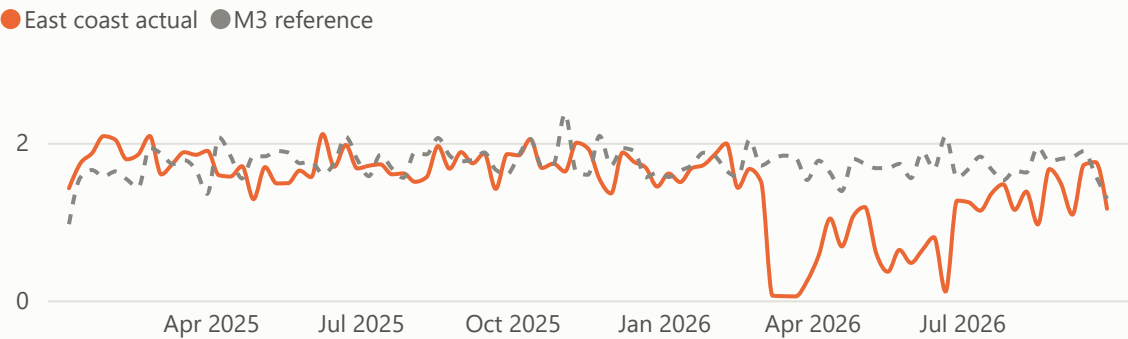
Weekly activity preserved (Gulf + east coast, % of the M3 reference)



UAE Gulf coast: weekly tonnes, actual vs M3 reference (Mt)



UAE east coast: weekly tonnes, actual vs M3 reference (Mt)



Ports: who lost, who absorbed

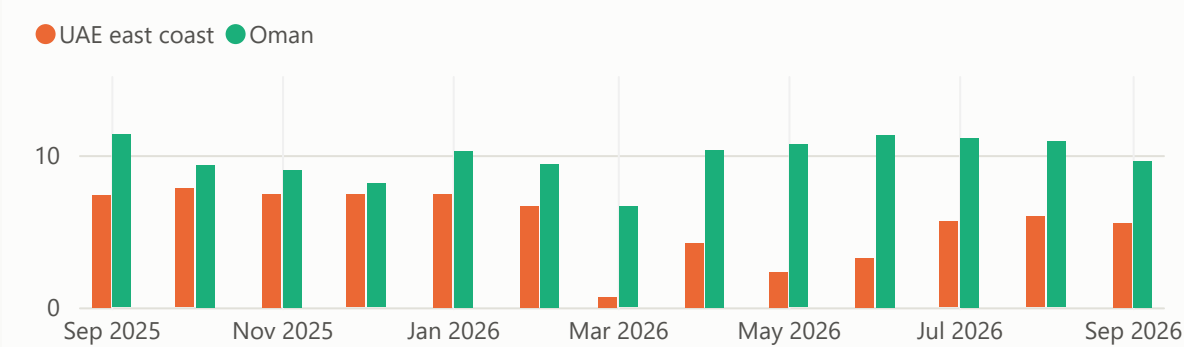
Since 1 Mar 2026 · index = observed tonnes ÷ M3 reference (1.00 = no change) · Oman for comparison only

Containers	General cargo + RoRo	Dry bulk	Tankers
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Tonnes by port since 1 Mar 2026 and index vs the M3 reference

Group	Port	Tonnes (Mt)	M3 reference (Mt)	Index
UAE Gulf coast	Jebel Ali	18.4	131.1	0.14
UAE Gulf coast	Mina Saqr	12.2	29.7	0.41
UAE Gulf coast	Abu Dhabi	9.0	3.0	3.01
UAE Gulf coast	Al Hamriyah LPG Terminal	5.2	11.0	0.47
UAE Gulf coast	Khalifa Port	2.5	19.5	0.13
UAE Gulf coast	Sharjah	2.3	3.7	0.63
UAE Gulf coast	Dubai	1.7	2.3	0.71
UAE Gulf coast	Jabal Az Zannah-Ruways	1.1	35.6	0.03
UAE Gulf coast	Das Island	0.6	4.3	0.15
UAE Gulf coast	Ajman	0.1	0.3	0.27
UAE Gulf coast	Zirku Island	0.1	0.0	2.28
UAE Gulf coast	Jebel Dhanna	0.0	0.0	0.97
UAE Gulf coast	Umm al Qaiwain	0.0	0.1	0.08
UAE east coast	Fujairah	23.5	49.5	0.47
UAE east coast	Khor Fakkan	4.1	1.8	2.24
Total		80.8	292.0	0.28

UAE east coast and Oman: monthly tonnes (Mt) — Oman for comparison only



Sustained observed throughput (thousand t per week)

Max 4-week average after the shock · UAE east coast and Oman · not capacity

Port	Containers	Dry bulk	General cargo + RoRo	Tankers
Duqm	30.0	98.0	14.7	137.0
Fujairah	70.0	405.1	18.7	942.2
Khor Fakkan	216.0	9.6	7.1	4.1
Port of Sohar	102.9	643.3	35.4	304.5
Salalah	1,219.7	476.4	15.5	97.8

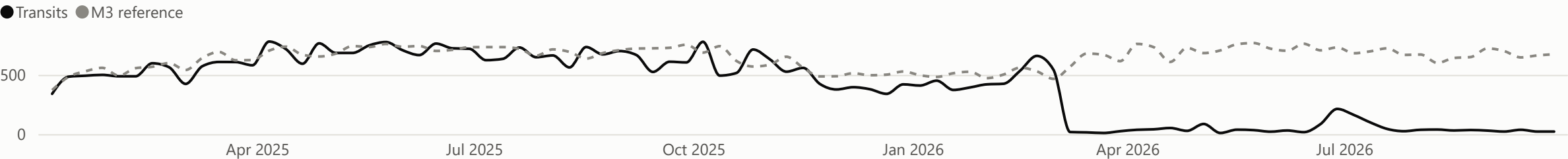
Transits through the Strait of Hormuz

Vessels per week (IMF PortWatch, Daily Chokepoints Data) · data to 27 Sep 2026 · PortWatch counts may differ from other sources (e.g. Lloyd’s List)

1/1/2025

9/27/2026

Weekly Hormuz transits vs the M3 reference (vessels)



Monthly transits by vessel type (2026)

Month	Tankers	Containers	Dry bulk	General cargo	RoRo	Total
Jan 2026	965	328	302	137	80	1812
Feb 2026	1217	370	376	150	79	2192
Mar 2026	29	12	45	13	0	99
Apr 2026	95	23	71	25	0	214
May 2026	40	9	35	36	2	122
Jun 2026	162	40	109	75	2	388
Jul 2026	148	30	79	53	6	316
Aug 2026	58	8	50	30	0	146
Sep 2026	28	7	44	21	0	100
Total	2742	827	1111	540	169	5389

Method, validation and data quality

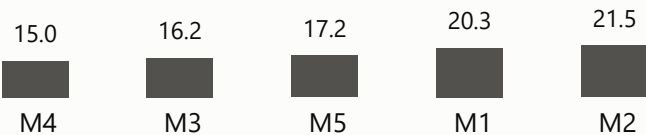
Definitions: project protocol v2.3, section 11 · Validated on changes, never on levels (tonnes vs TEU)

PortWatch vs DP World, AD Ports and Gulftainer (year-on-year change %; Khor Fakkan as a multiple)

Check	PortWatch	Official	Difference
Jebel Ali, containers, H1 2026 y/y	-58.9	-59.5	0.6
Jebel Ali, containers, Q2 2026 y/y	-90.9	-90.1	-0.8
Khalifa+Fujairah+Abu Dhabi, containers, Q2 2026 y/y	-77.4	-65.0	-12.4
Khor Fakkan, containers, Jun–Jul 2026 vs 2025 average (multiple)	11.3	8.1	3.2

Backtest: median weekly WAPE (%) by reference

Error without future information · lower = better



Definitions

- **M1**: same weekday, 52 weeks earlier.
- **M3 (main)**: average of the same weekday 52 and 104 weeks earlier.
- **M4**: average of the 8 weeks before 28 Feb 2026. M2 and M5: variants with a growth factor.
- **Sensitivity range**: minimum–maximum of M1 to M5; it measures the choice of reference and is not a confidence interval.
- **Backtest error**: Gulf-coast containers $\approx$ 9% (M3); east-coast containers 95%–235% depending on the reference. The east-coast compensation (4.2%–4.7%) is read as an order of magnitude, not an exact figure.
- **AIS measurement**: vessels without a signal, port-area boundaries and coverage add an error that is not quantified and differs from the two above.
- **Hormuz dependence index**: Gulf-coast share of Gulf + east coast; shown only together with activity preserved.
- **Sustained throughput**: sustained observed throughput; not capacity. Oman credited = 0.
- **Figure notes**: every published figure states period, segment, unit, ports, denominator, reference, source and code version.

Alerts to investigate by port (flagged weeks, Jan 2025 to Sep 2026)

Spike: > rolling median + 3 median deviations · jump: tonnes per call $\times$ 3 · not confirmed errors

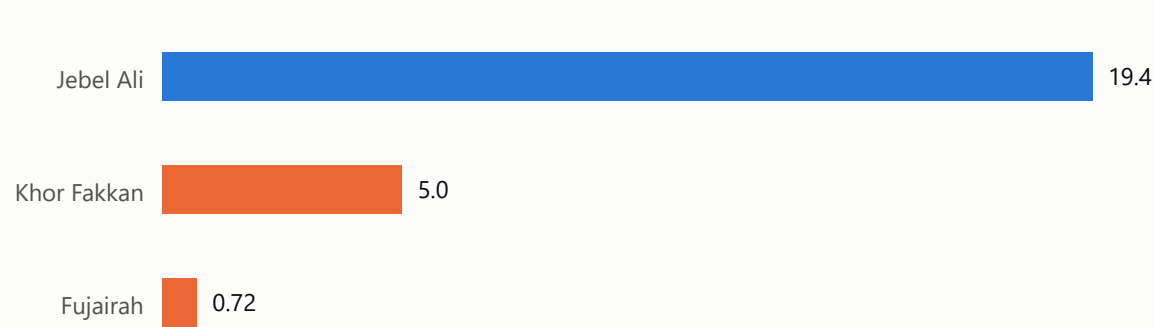
Port	jump in tonnes per call	tonnage spike	Total
Abu Dhabi	4	10	14
Al Hamriyah LPG Terminal		3	3
Das Island	16	11	27
Dubai	8	12	20
Duqm	2	6	8
Jabal Az Zannah-Ruways		2	2
Jebel Ali		1	1
Jebel Dhanna	10	20	30
Khalifa Port		9	9
Khor Fakkan	1	18	19
Mina Saqr		3	3
Port of Sohar		1	1
Salalah		3	3
Sharjah	2	6	8
Umm al Qaiwain		2	2
Zirku Island	2	2	4
Total	45	109	154

Why the east coast does not offset the Hormuz closure

Khor Fakkan and Fujairah received diverted cargo but do not replace Jebel Ali: size, specialization, pace vs declared capacity, and land connection

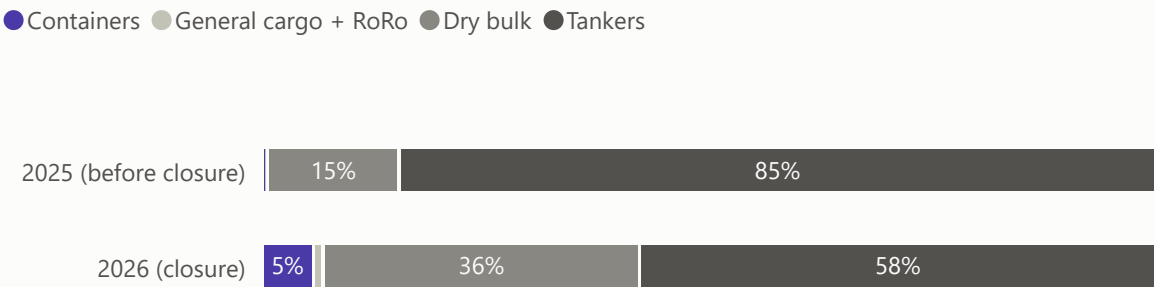
1. Size: container capacity declared by the operator (million TEU per year)

Khor Fakkan + Fujairah ≈ 5.7 M TEU, ~30% of Jebel Ali (which handled 15.5 M in 2024)



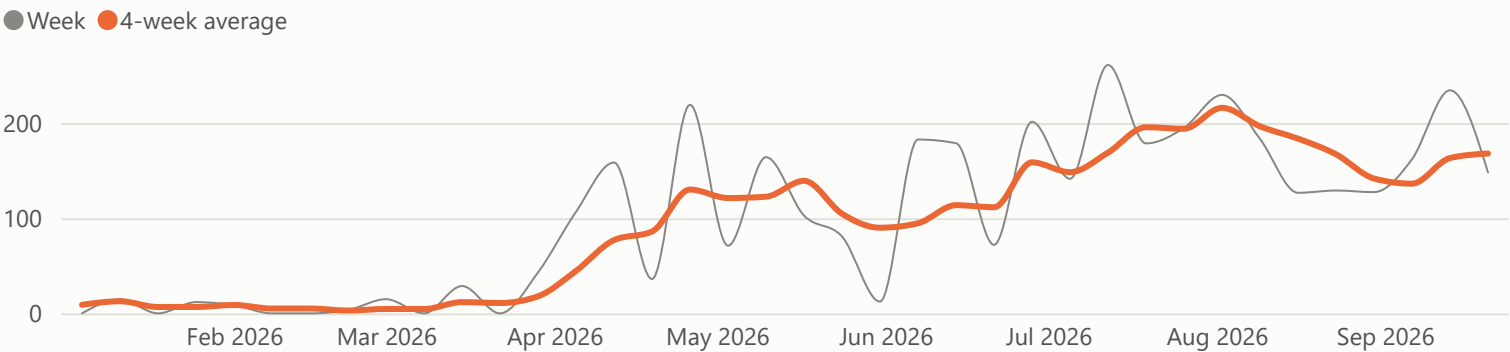
2. Specialization: use of Fujairah (% of tonnes, 1 Mar–25 Sep)

Oil port (~18 M m³ of storage); containers: from 0.1% to only 5%



3. Pace and declared capacity: Khor Fakkan containers (thousand t per week)

July: ~65k TEU/week (operator) ≈ 97% of the declared 3.5 M TEU/year; not measured occupancy · then –22%, cause not identified



4. Land connection

- **Rail:** Etihad Rail started Abu Dhabi–Fujairah freight on 27 Sep 2026, three times a week; Khor Fakkan is not included.
- **Trucks:** in March, a shortage of trucks and costly, slow multimodal routes were reported (AGBI).
- **Waiting times:** 2–8 Aug: median anchorage time of 9.3 days at Fujairah and 4.8 at Khor Fakkan, more than double the previous week (Portcast/Nautica; low confidence).

Reading

At its best run (4 weeks to 2 Aug), the east coast moved ~7% of the container tonnes of an average pre-closure Jebel Ali week (Jan 2025 to Feb 2026).

Untested hypotheses: that Khor Fakkan's decline reflects operating limits, and that land links constrain the east coast.